

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Cours

Lesson 2 Summary Sheet

TION – CION Cognate Trick

In this lesson, we explored the powerful TION – CION cognate trick. This trick involves taking English words that end in TION and changing the T to C while adding an accent over the last O. Examples include: creación, invitación, documentación, información, verificación.

This trick is highly effective, although not all words follow this pattern. For instance, "translation" becomes "traducción," not "translacion."

Spelling Changes in Cognates

S-ES: English words beginning with S followed by a consonant change by adding an E at the beginning: Speculation – especulación, station – estación, stipulation – estipulación, stigmatize – estigmatizar.

Double letters in English that don't change the sound of the word: Recommendation – recomendación, communication – comunicación, illumination – iluminación.

For words where double letters are important for pronunciation, they remain unchanged: Cooperation – cooperación.

Double RR words tend to stay the same and require you to make the trill: Narration – narración, irritation – irritación.

Some cognates may have spelling changes in the root of the word: Demonstration – demostración, immigration – inmigración, humiliation – humillación.

One more spelling change: TH becomes T: Authorization – autorización.

Gender of Nouns in Spanish

Every noun in Spanish has a gender, either masculine or feminine. This assignment seems random for inanimate objects and must be learned with each new word. Masculine nouns often end in O: libro (book), carro (car), vino (wine), cuento (story), barco (boat). However, some do not: árbol (tree), mar (sea), sol (sun), dolor (pain).

Feminine nouns often end in A: casa (house), escuela (school), mesa (table), isla (island). Some exceptions include: lección (lesson), flor (flower), ciudad (city), imagen (image).

All nouns created with the TION – CION cognate trick are feminine, making it easier to know which definite and indefinite articles to use. For example, "option" becomes "opción": La opción (the option), las opciones (the options), una opción (an option), unas opciones (some options).

When pluralizing, add S after a vowel and ES after a consonant: La decoración, una decoración, las decoraciones, unas decoraciones.

Definite and Indefinite Articles

Masculine Nouns:

- **Definite Articles:**
 - Singular: el (the)
 - Example: el libro (the book)
 - Plural: los (the)
 - Example: los libros (the books)
- **Indefinite Articles:**
 - Singular: un (a)
 - Example: un libro (a book)
 - Plural: unos (some)
 - Example: unos libros (some books)

Feminine Nouns:

- **Definite Articles:**
 - Singular: la (the)
 - Example: la opción (the option)
 - Plural: las (the)
 - Example: las opciones (the options)
- **Indefinite Articles:**
 - Singular: una (an)
 - Example: una opción (an option)
 - Plural: unas (some)
 - Example: unas opciones (some options)

Making Verbs from Nouns

Nouns created using the TION – CION trick can be transformed into verbs if they end in ACION by dropping CION and adding R:

Observation – observación – observar (to observe)

Information – información – informar (to inform)

Recommendation – recomendación – recomendar (to recommend)

If the CION word does not end in ACION, it cannot be made into a verb: Opción, ficción, acción.

Practice Sentences with Verbs

Using the verb "querer" (to want), you can form sentences by adding the infinitive (unconjugated verb): Quiero + Infinitive (I want to do something)

Examples:

1. I want to memorize the information – Quiero memorizar la información.
2. I want to participate – Quiero participar.
3. I want to examine the documentation – Quiero examinar la documentación.
4. I want to organize the information – Quiero organizar la información.
5. I want to celebrate – Quiero celebrar.
6. I want to certify the information – Quiero certificar la información.
7. I want to cooperate – Quiero cooperar.
8. I want to collaborate – Quiero colaborar.
9. I want to confirm the description – Quiero confirmar la descripción.
10. I want to continue the conversation – Quiero continuar la conversación.
11. I want to prepare the documentation – Quiero preparar la documentación.
12. I want to verify the information – Quiero verificar la información.
13. I want to decorate the house – Quiero decorar la casa.

Negative form using "no quiero" (I don't want): I don't want to speculate – No quiero especular. I don't want to decorate the house – No quiero decorar la casa.

Conclusion

By recognizing language patterns and using your reasoning skills, you can translate sentences and expand your Spanish vocabulary effectively. If you enjoy learning Spanish through patterns, make sure to watch the next lesson.